



Order Ahead + Pickup System Brief

Launch workflow, inventory logic, pickup method and future system roadmap.

part bakery. part product lab.

Ridgway, Colorado

1. Purpose

This brief defines how the madebutter. order ahead and pickup system should work at launch and how it should grow over time. The goal is simple for guests and powerful for staff: customers only see what is ready or available today while the staff system manages menu state, counts, order flow and future production layers.

Launch target: menu browsing, order ahead, Stripe payment, name label pickup, ready notification and menu inventory admin. Push scheduled pickup slots, accounts, suggestion loop, rack stage inventory and lockers to phase two.

2. System Snapshot

Layer	Current status	Role
Storefront menu	Built and dynamic through Supabase.	Shows active products, today availability, stock states and add to cart.
Cart sheet	Built as floating cart plus slide up sheet.	Lets guests review quantities before checkout.
Checkout	Built as contact then payment.	Collects contact and notification preference before payment.
Stripe	Sandbox set up, wiring next phase.	Custom branded checkout with Stripe behind the scenes.
Admin menu	Built.	Edit products, images, price, availability, stock and sort order.
Orders board	Planned.	Staff columns for New, Preparing and Ready.
Notifications	Email ready through Resend, SMS scaffolded.	Confirmation and ready messages.

3. Guest Order Flow

The guest should not have to understand production, rack counts, par bake timing or staff workflow. They should see a beautiful menu, choose available items, pay quickly and get a clear pickup next step.

Step	Guest action	System behavior
Browse	Customer views the home page menu.	Only active products appear. Available products are bright. Not today products are dim. Sold out products show a sold out pill.
Add	Customer taps plus on a product tile.	Cart updates immediately and inventory limits prevent ordering more than exists.
Cart	Customer reviews items in slide up sheet.	Quantities, item prices and tax included totals are clear.
Contact	Customer enters contact and chooses SMS or email.	System stores order contact and notification preference.
Payment	Customer pays through custom branded Stripe flow.	Stripe handles payment behind the scenes with atomic inventory decrement on paid orders.
Confirmation	Customer lands on receipt page.	Receipt number, order summary and pickup note display.

Step	Guest action	System behavior
Pickup	Customer gets notified when ready.	Staff marks order ready and message sends by email or SMS.

4. Launch Pickup Method

The cleanest launch pickup is name label shelf pickup with staff handoff available at the counter. Lockers should remain future. Pickup times should start simple with ready soon, we will notify you. Scheduled windows can come later after the team understands demand and bake timing.

Pickup choice	Launch recommendation	Why
Name label shelf	Use for paid order ahead pickup.	Simple, fast and does not require hardware.
Counter handoff	Use when staff wants to protect quality or answer questions.	Helpful for hot items, large orders and first time customers.
Pickup windows	Phase two.	Slot limits require production data first.
Lockers	Future only.	Great for the brand but not needed at launch.

5. Order Status Standard

The orders board should be built around clear staff columns. The customer should receive only the information that matters. For launch, the key customer message is confirmation and ready for pickup.

Status	Staff meaning	Customer visibility
Received	Paid order came in and needs review.	Order confirmed.
Preparing	Staff is boxing, warming or assembling.	Optional later. Not needed at launch.
Ready	Order is labeled and ready on shelf or counter.	Ready notification sends.
Picked up	Order has left the store.	No notification required.
Canceled	Order is voided before fulfillment.	Customer should receive a clear message.
Refunded	Payment has been refunded.	Customer should receive refund language.

6. Inventory Logic

Inventory is already built at the item level. Staff can turn on track inventory, set how many were made today, adjust counts manually and let the storefront enforce limits. The customer sees only finished sellable quantity. The kitchen can evolve toward rack stages later.

Inventory state	Launch behavior	Future behavior
Available today	Staff flips item on and sets quantity.	Can connect to daily production plan.
Low stock	Storefront shows only N left at six or fewer.	Can trigger staff prompt to prep or bake more.
Sold out	Automatic when tracked stock reaches zero.	Can support replacement suggestions.
Hidden	Inactive products disappear entirely.	Useful for seasonal items and tests.

Inventory state	Launch behavior	Future behavior
Ready rack count	Manual count added to available today.	Can become a rack stage with tray entry.
Prepped count	Not customer visible at launch.	Future staff pipeline.

7. Production to Inventory Workflow

The system should support the way the bakery actually works. Donuts, kolaches and stuffed rolls are prepped before service, then finished fresh. Staff should add sellable counts when product reaches the rack, not when dough or filling is still in production.

Stage	Staff action	Inventory rule
Planned	Production decides target count for tomorrow or today.	Do not show to customers.
Prepped	Doughs, fillings or inserts are mixed, molded, chilled or held.	Do not add to customer inventory.
Ready to finish	Items are proofed, baked, fried or ready for final cooking.	Still staff only unless the team wants a production view.
Cooling or setting	Items are cooling, glazing or being packaged.	Do not add until quality is approved.
Ready rack	Finished items are on rack, in sleeve or in case.	Add to available inventory. Customers and staff can buy them.
Packed order	Items are assigned to a paid order.	Reduce inventory through checkout and hold for pickup.

Rule: ready inventory means a customer could walk in, point to the item and leave with it. Anything before that is production inventory, not storefront inventory.

8. Rack Count Workflow for Donuts

Donuts need a simple rack count workflow because they can be finished in waves. A staff member should be able to add counts as trays are approved. Later this can become a richer rack screen with stages like ready to fry, fried and cooling, glazed and set and ready rack.

Action	Example	System need
Finish tray	A tray of twelve matcha milk rings is glazed and set.	Staff opens item and adds twelve to today inventory.
Partial tray	Six maple bars pass quality and four need repair.	Staff adds only six.
Walk in sale	Customer buys two from the rack.	POS reduces the same ready inventory count.
Order ahead sale	Customer buys four online.	Stripe paid order atomically decrements count.
Waste or staff comp	Two items are removed.	Staff adjusts count down with a reason later.

9. Menu Availability Rules

State	Customer display	Staff control
Active and available	Bright product tile with plus button.	is_active on, is_available_today on and stock available if tracked.
Not today	Dim and grey with no normal add behavior.	is_available_today off.
Sold out	Sold out pill and disabled purchase.	Tracked stock reaches zero.
Hidden	Does not appear.	is_active off.
Low stock	Only N left message.	Triggered automatically at six or fewer.

10. Notifications

Notifications should feel useful and quiet. Email through Resend is ready. SMS through Twilio is scaffolded but not live. The ready message should fire when staff marks the order ready.

Message	Timing	Copy direction
Order confirmation	Immediately after paid checkout.	Your madebutter. order is in. Receipt number and pickup note.
Ready for pickup	When staff marks ready.	Your madebutter. order is ready. Come on in.
Sold out replacement	Future exception flow.	Keep human and direct. Offer replacement or refund.
Pickup reminder	Future scheduled pickup support.	Use only if needed. Do not spam.
Refund	When refund is processed.	Clear refund language and support contact.

11. Staff Admin and POS Vision

The admin should feel like the storefront with more control. Desktop can use side navigation. Mobile and iPad can use bottom navigation. Staff should be able to manage products, availability, inventory, orders and future POS without leaving the madebutter. design language.

Tool	Launch or future	Role
Menu admin	Built for launch.	Edit item content, pricing, images, availability, inventory and sort order.
Orders board	Next major build.	Move orders through New, Preparing and Ready.
Staff POS	Phase two or late launch.	Counter register with same inventory pool.
Customer payment screen	Phase two.	Customer facing card tap or wallet flow.
Self checkout kiosk	Future.	Grab and go self service with inventory awareness.
Hero admin	Planned.	Update slideshow images and copy without code.

12. Suggestion Loop Integration

The suggestion form is not required for launch but should influence the system design. Suggestions should be anonymous friendly, stored in Supabase and reviewed by staff. Strong ideas can become test batches, limited drops and eventually menu items. The order system should be ready for rotating flavors and daily drops because

the menu already supports availability and stock control.

Step	Meaning
Submit	Guest suggests a flavor, filling, glaze or product idea.
Review	Staff tags, archives or marks as promising.
Test	Kitchen makes a small batch and photographs it.
Drop	Item appears as a limited daily product with stock count.
Decide	Strong sellers move closer to staple or second tier status.

13. Launch Decisions Needed

- Confirm pickup method for launch: name label shelf, counter handoff or a simple hybrid.
- Confirm ready soon language versus scheduled pickup windows for launch.
- Finalize real prices for all lunch rolls before Stripe goes live.
- Confirm tax included pricing remains the customer facing standard.
- Decide which notifications launch first: confirmation and ready are enough to start.
- Decide whether walk in sales use the same inventory count through POS at launch or shortly after.
- Define who can adjust counts and whether adjustments need a reason.

14. Phase Roadmap

Phase	Scope
Launch	Dynamic menu, order ahead, Stripe payment, tax included totals, confirmation page, name label pickup, ready notification, inventory admin and menu admin.
Phase two	Orders board, staff POS, scheduled pickup slots, suggestion form, hero admin, about admin and richer notifications.
Phase three	Rack stage inventory, customer accounts, saved payment, order history, self checkout kiosk, customer payment screen and grab and go flow.
Future	Pickup lockers, deeper production planning, community driven drops, wholesale or event modes and predictive production counts.